

SUPPLEMENT: THE IMPORTANCE OF COMMUNICATION SKILLS FOR STUDENTS

Complete the following text by filling in the proper word for each of the blank spaces (1 – 10).

Write **ONE WORD ONLY** in each space.

Communication is the process of exchanging information (1) _____ ideas between two or more individuals or entities. It involves a sender transmitting a message through a chosen medium such as speech, writing, or gesture to a receiver, who then interprets and responds to the message. Effective communication requires both parties to understand the (2) _____ language or code, and to share a common context or frame of reference.

COMMUNICATION SKILLS ARE ESSENTIAL FOR:

ACADEMIC SUCCESS: Effective communication is crucial for academic success. Students with strong communication skills can express (3) _____ ideas clearly and concisely, making it easier for them to participate in class discussions, ask questions, and seek help when needed. They can also present their thoughts and arguments persuasively, leading (4) _____ better grades on presentations, papers, and exams.

COLLABORATION AND TEAMWORK: Communication skills play a vital role in collaborative projects and group work. Students who can communicate effectively can express their viewpoints, actively listen to (5) _____, and contribute constructively to team discussions. This fosters a positive and productive group dynamic, enhancing the overall quality of the project and the learning experience.

BUILDING RELATIONSHIPS: Communication skills are essential for establishing and maintaining relationships with peers, teachers, and mentors. Effective communication helps students connect (6) _____ others, express empathy, resolve conflicts, and establish a supportive network. Strong interpersonal skills enable students to form meaningful relationships that can positively impact their academic and personal lives.

CONFIDENCE AND SELF-EXPRESSION: When students possess good communication skills, they feel more confident expressing their thoughts, ideas, and opinions. (7) _____ are more likely to actively participate in class, share their perspectives, and engage in discussions. This confidence extends beyond the classroom and can lead to better overall self-expression, both verbally and in written form.

CRITICAL THINKING AND PROBLEM-SOLVING: Communication skills are closely linked to critical thinking and problem-solving abilities. Effective communication requires organising thoughts, analysing information, and articulating arguments. (8) _____ improving their communication skills, students develop better reasoning and analytical skills, enabling them to approach complex problems more systematically and find creative solutions.

CAREER READINESS: (9) _____ the professional world, strong communication skills are highly valued by employers. Students who possess effective communication skills have a competitive edge (10) _____ entering the job market. They can effectively convey their qualifications, collaborate with colleagues, and interact with clients and customers. Good communication skills are often considered a fundamental requirement for leadership roles and career advancement.

PRACTICE:

Complete the following text by filling in the proper word for each of the blank spaces (1 – 10).

Write **ONE WORD ONLY** in each space.

The world-renowned Cambridge University is considering **abolishing** handwritten exams (1) _____ 800 years. University officials may ask students to type their exam answers on a computer rather (2) _____ use a pen. The move follows complaints from examination markers who say they are finding test papers increasingly **illegible** (3) _____ to poor handwriting. Academics say today's students primarily use laptops in lectures and tutorials instead of pens. Students are losing the ability to write by hand. One academic said asking students to hand-write exams actually causes them physical difficulties. (4) _____ muscles in their hand are not used to writing extensively (5) _____ **prolonged** periods of two to three hours.

A Cambridge University lecturer, Dr Sarah Pearsall, told Britain's 'Daily Telegraph' newspaper that handwriting was becoming **a "lost art"**. She said: "Twenty years (6) _____, students routinely [wrote] by hand several hours a day, but now they write virtually nothing by hand, (7) _____ exams." She added: "We have been concerned for years (8) _____ the declining handwriting problem. There has definitely been **a downward trend**. It is difficult for both the students and the examiners as it is harder and harder to read these [exam] scripts." Dr Pearsall says some students' handwriting is (9) _____ illegible that they had to return to the university over the summer to read their answers out loud to examiners who (10) _____ not read their writing.

Which of the definitions / explanations below (a - l) would be an **appropriate** way of **communicating** the meaning of the following words/phrases (1 - 5) in a classroom setting.

There is ONLY ONE CORRECT answer for each.

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| ___ 1) The word abolish ... | a) ...means something is lower than before. |
| ___ 2) If something is illegible ... | b) ...is a skill or practice that requires specialized knowledge but is no longer widely performed by people. |
| ___ 3) To prolong means... | c) ...than I can't read something. |
| ___ 4) A "lost art" ... | d) ... is a pattern of gradual decrease or worsening over time, meaning something is becoming smaller, less valuable, or is in decline. |
| ___ 5) A downward trend ... | e) ...is to cancel. |
| | f) ... to make something last a longer time. |
| | g) ...is the opposite of a "found art". |
| | h) ...means to put an end to something, such as an organization, rule, or custom. |
| | i) ...that it is now longer. |
| | j) ...then it is impossible or almost impossible to read because of being very untidy or not clear. |
| | k) ...is like a painting that I cannot find. |
| | l) ...means to delay an event and plan or decide that it should happen at a later date or time. |

Which ONE of the following sentences (a - e) expresses the MAIN IDEA / MAIN POINT of the text above?

- a) Students now use laptops during classes instead of pen and paper.
- b) Examiners at Cambridge University are having a very hard time reading what students write by hand.
- c) University lecturers have been troubled by the worsening handwriting problem for years.
- d) Cambridge University is looking at getting rid of handwritten exams after hundreds of years.
- e) Student handwriting has gotten worse and worse over the last 20 years.